

As Diablos Whip Miners

Baseball Returns To El Paso

By MARK LEIBSON
Times Sports Writer

Jimmy Williams promised an exciting baseball team when he came to El Paso and he kept his word.

Using what ever methods conceivable to move his base runners ahead on the bases, Williams' El Paso Diablos relied on strong pitching and nifty base running while downing the University of Texas at El Paso 12-2 Wednesday night at Dudley Field.

Six times, the Miners under Coach Andy Cohen were left holding the empty glove as five Diablos shared in one of the greatest base robberies of the century at the home of the Rojos.

The evening started out a bit shakey for Williams' squad which had never played under the lights during spring training back at Holtville, Calif.

After two Miner players found their exits by way of a strikeout and an infield groundout off Diablo starter Bill Rothan, things started happening that don't usually occur to a Class AA baseball team.

Glenn Villarreal singled for U.T. El Paso and went to second on right fielder Gil Flores poor judgement of the grounder. Keith Rushing was hit by a pitch and Joey Pennies was safe at first on another error by Lawrence Rush which allowed Villarreal to score one half of U.T. El Paso's total for the evening.

A catcher's interference call against Diablo catcher Dave Christiansen loaded the bases but Rothan ended the uproar by forcing Steve Dau to bounce to short.

"I'm not trying to make excuses," said Williams. "But this was the first time this year we've played under the lights. I'm not worried. These kids looked alright."

Williams' players decided the outcome in their half of the first inning when Kent Froede walked with one out and went to third on Carlos Lopez' double down the right field line.

Designated hitter Randy Wilson, a towering lefthander, reached first when

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Art Bravo bobbled his grounder at second allowing Froede to score. Rush followed with a run scoring single and while Paul Dade was at the plate, Manager Williams called for a delayed steal which worked to perfection as Rush went to second while Wilson scored.

Dade then doubled Rush across and after El Paso's first inning in Dudley Field, the Diablos led 4-1.

From that point, it was a matter of time as to what the final score in favor of the Diablos would be as Cohen allowed 20 of his players to face professional competition.

Rothan worked only three innings and struck out five players. Jim Officer, a starter for the Rojos in 1974 as El Paso captured the Texas League's Western Division, worked the following two innings without giving up a run.

"I just found out Monday that I was going to be in the bullpen," said Officer before the exhibition contest began. "It was kind of a surprise for me and I'm kind of looking forward to seeing how I do."

Officer's first relief performance was a good indication that the California Angels' officials knew their business.

Williams used three other pitchers from his staff the final four innings and they were untouchable by their U.T. El Paso opponents.

Mike Overy went two frames and struck out three batters while former Diablo Frank Kenyon and newcomer John Verhoeven each worked one inning on the mound while accumulating a strikeout apiece.

El Paso will hold day-night workouts tomorrow at Dudley Field before catching a bus to Midland at 8 a.m. Friday for the Texas League season opener against the Cubs that night.

Following the five-game series, the Devils return to Dudley Field for their home-opener against the Shreveport Captains April 17. San Antonio's Brewers will follow the Captains into town to conclude the 12-game homestand.

Top Duels Expected In Miners Triangular Meet

By FLIP MORIN
Times Sports Writer

Both Nebraska and Arizona will have full squads at the triangular meet 6 p.m., Saturday hosted by the University of Texas at El Paso Miners at Kidd Field. Coach Ted Banks feels the running should bring some top duels.

In the 100-yard dash, for instance, Arizona's Larry Brown has a 9.4, Charley Nash, 9.5, Wardell Gilbreath, 9.7 with Nebraska's Chuck Malito a 9.8.

Banks has Paul Njoroge with a 9.7 (9.1 wind-aided), Colin Thurton 9.4 (wind-

Frank Munene, Jeff Dember and Ruben Dominguez will run the mile for the Miners.

Their chief opponents will be Ed Arriola of Arizona with a 4:08.2 and possibly Ed Mendoza if he doesn't decide to try for the three-mile stint.

The Cornhuskers have a strong bid in sophomore Keith Whitaker who has run a 4:08.8 recently against Colorado State.

Mendoza may start for the Wildcats in the three-miler, if so, he'll be their only hope.

Banks has Larry Brown, Tony Zuniga, Kip Sirma and Gibson Gatei entered.

close," he said. "Of course we're not at 100 per cent in some events like we'd like to be, but we can't take any chances on using those questionable athletes with the WAC and the NCAA championships just around the corner."

Larry Jessee said Wednesday that he would definitely be a contender in the pole vault Saturday. "If I get that new pole I'll be going for a world record," he said "Oh, forget that, I'm going for the world record with whatever pole feels best," he added.

High jumper Greg Joy will probably sit this meet out, as he pulled a groin muscles this week. That to go along with a sore face